

2003:- Vajpayee's visit resulting into Strategic Partnership.

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— Strategic Partnership on Global Issues like Climate Change, WTO, World Order. (Multi-Polar World).

↳ For this purpose Russia—India—China triangle came into existence.

What happened at Bilateral Front ?

i) For the 1st time China recognised Sikkim as Indian territory. Therefore, Border Trade at Nathula Pass started.

ii) In context of Border Dispute — the two parties agreed to resolve the Border Dispute in a peaceful manner. For this, concrete steps to be taken —

a) Establishment of a Mechanism of Special Representative. It symbolises upgradation. ~~It~~ From Joint Working Group led by military officials, the talks had been upgraded to the political level. (NSA level talks).

b) They decided that the 1st task of the special Representative will be to formulate "Guiding Principles and Political Parameters" for Resolution of Disputes

In 2005, special Representative produce the formula.

What are the Guiding Principles? -

- Based on Panchasheel — it was agreed that any solution will be based on Mutual Respect and from the position of Equality. It means India should not feel as a weaker Party.

It was decided that both Parties will go for Mutual adjustment.

It was decided that Geographical Considerations, the sentiments of the People, Practical Difficulties will be taken into Consideration.

It was decided that Resolution will take place in 3 Stages! -

• 1st Stage - Ground Work - conducting Surveys.

• 3rd Stage! - Delineation of Boundary.

• 2nd Stage! - Exchange of Maps.

What is the Progress? -

India - China border talks are conducted with utmost Secrecy. As per Media Reports, 1st two Stages are completed. It means Resolution of Border Dispute is almost ripe. It is a low - Hanging Fruit.

India is getting impatient to taste the Fruits. Solving the border dispute is India's Priorities and not China's. China was not interested even, it was only Biding time.

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Why India wants to solve the dispute? -

-A/c to GoI, the most important reason behind the trust deficit.

Why China does not want to solve the dispute with India with urgency?

i) Trust deficit with India. — Till Tibet issue is not resolved a/c to China's satisfaction, China wants to keep India under pressure.

What is China's solution over Tibet issue? -

China is waiting for Dalai lama to die.

China has passed an Act on succession. Next Dalai lama will be appointed by China.

* Who will be the Next Dalai lama? -

-A/c to Dalai lama, there will be no Re-incarnation.

What India should do?

India should get the New Dalai lama on board to determine his successor.

At least, India should get other lama's back.

For Ex- India should get Karmapa lama.

China thinks that if Border issue is resolved, India will have free hand in promoting insurgency in Tibet.

Tibet is the only Card India has against China. W/out Tibet, India's position is of "Damn if they do & dammed if they don't." If India support Tibetan cause the trust deficit will continue.

Since, there is a trust deficit, India can't trust China. In case, India give up the Tibbetan Card (Dalai lama).

What has been India's policy w.r.t Tibet?

— the Balancing Act. It means supporting Tibetan cause but not hold heartedly, so that it does not alienate China. For ex - India has given asylum to Tibetan Refugees, has allowed the Provisional Govt. to operate, yet not allow Tibetans to protest against China.

India has been reluctant to raise the issue of Human Rights violations of Tibetans.

Thus, India is not seen by Tibbetans as a serious Stakeholders. India has lost the leadership of Tibetan issue to the West.

Time is running fast, hence should come up with clarity what India wants to do with the Tibet Card. There has been lot of inconsistency in the Posture of GoI w.r.t Tibet.

Neither we have been able to gain the trust of China nor we have been able to create enough pressure on China with the way we have used the Card.

When P.M. Modi came to Power, it was felt that he will go with "Hard ball Diplomacy" with China on Tibet issue.

The Tibetan P.M. Lobsang Sangway was invited to the oath taking Ceremony in 2014 but his name was dropped in 2019.

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GoI permitted conference on democracy by Uighur ~~descendants~~ dissidents and Tibetans but called off the conference later.

India gave permission to organise "Thank You India Occasion" w/c was also cancelled.

Modi openly wish Dalai lama on his birthday. At the same time, BJP leader Ram Madhav had to withdraw his tweet where he was seen attending the Funeral of the soldier of special Frontier Force. Hence, it is suggested that India should not move on two boats.

Tibetan issue became more complicated as a new angle has been added.

↳ Geopolitics of Water.

Tibet is known as "Water Tower". China has scarcity of water. China has a plan for diversion of water from South to North. China is constructing large no. of Dams on Brahmaputra. Uptil now China has been denying any such thing as building of Dam. However, when Satellite imageries came to limelight China accepted the building of Dam.

China's Dam building activity on Brahmaputra (Tsang Po) will not impact the availability of water on India's side. However, the major concern is China using the Dam for strategic purposes.

These are not run of the River ^{Schemes} ~~Stream~~, They are huge Reservoir Dams. Recently, China has launched the project of building the mega Dam at the Great Bend. → In proximity to Arunachal Pradesh.

Impact :-

- i) China can release the water to flood North East during Wars.
- ii) Since dams are situated in Seismic Zone. There can be accidental disaster.

China has already started diverting the Industrial Pollution in Brahmaputra.

Recent Dam w/c China is building is many times bigger than the 3 ~~Gorges~~ ^{Gorges} Dams — World's Biggest dam. (w/c is also in China).

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A/c to Indian Strategist, Brahma Chellany, the Future war in Asia will be Water War.

A/c to Uttam Sinha, expert on India - China Hydro - Politics, water issue b/w India - China is too complicated.

What is China's attitude w.r.t Water ? -

- i) Unlike India, w/c co-operates with neighbours on water, China does not co-operate with India.
- ii) China exercises all the Rights of the Upper Riparian State whereas India is not able to exercise the Rights of lower Riparian State.

Whenever, India had planned to built dams on its side in Arunachal Pradesh, China has raised objection. In the past, China has compelled ADB to cancel the project. China's "increasing Economy" might influence the decision of Financial Institution.

(Asian Development Bank)

Nevertheless, India has recently announced its plan to built a Mega Dam in Arunachal Pradesh (in 2023).

Uptil now, India - China Hydro - Diplomacy has been confined to highly irregular release of Data.

In 2002, India - China agreed to share data on Brahmaputra and in 2007, share data on Sutley River.

China does not provide data on time. China also charges money for data whereas India provides Data to South Asian Neighbours for Free.

What India should do ? -

- i) Work with countries like - Nepal, Bangladesh who will also be affected in case of disaster to pressurise China who is trying to be in their Good books.
- ii) India can exercise the principles of International law. One of the principles of International law is prior appropriation Rights.

↳ It means on such trans-boundary resources, whichever country takes 1st Action, it becomes its Rights. It means India should go for construction of dam on its size. Thus, assert its Rights on Brahmaputra.

Hence, India has started the plan for construction of Dam.

Problem :-

- India has to ensure that the mega dam plan in Arunachal should not destroy the Fragile Ecology, it should take local into confident, there should be proper Rehabilitation in case of displacement. otherwise, we will allow China to open New Front against India — China can promote subversion in North East.

What is China's Strategy to deal with India?

— to divide India. Means to promote internal division using Fault lines in Indian Society.

Fault lines:-

i) Hindu - muslim:- For w/c China uses Pakistan.

ii) Ethnic diversity in North - East:- China has many cards to play -

a) China can use -

i) Bangladesh - to promote illegal immigration w/c can de-stabilise North - East.

ii) Myanmar - to push Rohingyas towards North - East and de-stabilise.

b) China can provide aids to insurgent group on India - Myanmar Border.

Why China wants to divide India? -

- B/c China thinks that only divided India is easy to win. Though Chinese always talk about India as inferior civilisation and look upon India with disdain. Yet, in reality they believe that it is not easy to defeat India. India can give tough fight. Geographical conditions in Himalaya are more favourable to India -

i) Chinese mainland is so far.

ii) There is a insurgency in this region.

iii) Except India, no other country in the world as of now has expertise in "High - Altitude Warfare".

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From very beginning, China has been supporting Left. (Maoist).

China has a well institutionalised policy to promote sub-version in other countries.

A/c to Mao, there are 3 Magic weapon China has -

- weapon to be used in both domestic & External Front.

Weapon :-

i) The Communist Party.

ii) Peoples Liberation Army.

iii) Propaganda -

- for propaganda, China has a special institution. United Front Work Department, a special organ of Communist Party of China to promote Propaganda.

Why China is not in urgency to solve the Border issue?

- China kept on delaying the finalisation of the Resolution, because China was biding time. It means China would solve the issue only when China develops the distinctive Edge over India. China does not believe in 'Mutual Respect', but it believes in dictating the terms of the Deal.

What is the current state of :-

- i) India - China Relations.
- ii) India - China border dispute.

What is the Future of India - China Relations.

How to read China's mind ? -

- Very easy as Xi - Xingping has a habit of giving the clear timelines.

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- i) Xi - Xingping came to power in 2012. In 2012, itself, he gave his "China Dream". China dream implies the Great Rejuvenation of the Chinese Nation. For this he keeps on proposing centenary Goal.

1st Centenary Goal is to end the century of Humiliation. It started with the Opium War.

The biggest Humiliation is the occupation of Chinese territory by Imperialist. This includes India.

India has occupied Chinese territory. (Arunachal, Sikkim, Ladakh, Andaman & Nicobar).

In 2015, China published a document where it mentions 6 wars China is sure to fight in next 50 years. South Tibet is the third war mentioned.

In 2017, ^{declared that it} ~~By 2070~~, China¹ will become World Power with Pioneering Global influence by 2049.

↳ it means promoting Chinese Model.

How do they describe it ? -

- By Community of Common destiny.

The Guiding theme of BRI.

By 2027, Military Modernisation of China will be complete.

By 2050, China will become the leading space power.